Office of Economic Development (OED) | Community Development Project Coordinator (CDPC)
Position Currently held by Vincent McCoy

The **Community Development Project Coordinator (CDPC)** serves as a critical operational catalyst within the **Office of Economic Development (OED)**, directly supporting the business community, driving the city's commercial district vitality, small business resilience, and commercial corridor health. By managing essential merchant relations, facilitating cross-departmental policy implementation, and serving as a bridge between the city and local business communities, this role directly translates into measurable local impact.

*CDPC - Functional Task Breakdown & Workload Allocation*

**Commercial District Support & Governance**

- **Workload Allocation**: **35% of total time** (~14 hours/week).
- **Primary Impact**: Serves as the primary point of contact for five business areas: Lorin, North Shattuck, Telegraph, Solano, and Elmwood.
- **Key Responsibilities**: Regularly attends board meetings, supports community events, and interfaces directly with local merchants and property owners. Fulfills formal city administrative governance mandates by serving as the Commission Secretary for both the Solano and Elmwood districts, contributing to the Telegraph BID Board of Directors and serving on the Executive Committee, and routinely analyzing district financial statements to ensure fiscal health of our city's Business Improvement Districts (BIDs) and merchant organizations.

**Business Assistance, Permitting & Inquiries**

- **Workload Allocation**: **25% of total time** (~10 hours/week).
- **Primary Impact**: Functions as a front-line communications and navigation hub for Berkeley's business and commercial real estate sectors.
- **Key Responsibilities**: Directs the resolution of inquiries to OED communication channels (email and phone), resolves 5–6 substantial and often complex inquiries per week. Manages a steady pipeline of 2–3 real estate queries weekly from both internal divisions like Health, Housing, and Community Services (HHCS) and external partners (small businesses, non-profit organizations, solo entrepreneurs, etc.) seeking to get established or expand in Berkeley. Provides hands-on technical support for 4–5 cases each week (that may come in from other sources including council districts, merchant organizations, business events, etc.), which can include assisting individual small business owners directly, as well as commercial brokerage firms like Norheim & Yost and Gordon Commercial alongside their clients as they look for suitable locations to get established in Berkeley.

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**Financial Programs & Contract Management**

- **Workload Allocation**: **15% of total time** (~6 hours/week).
- **Primary Impact**: Secures small business longevity and operational continuity through formal financial stewardship and strategic third-party program management.
- **Key Responsibilities**: Directs the administrative framework of the city's Revolving Loan Fund (RLF) and Resiliency Loan Programs (RLP), serving as the Secretary for the Loan Administration Board. Coordinates with the Finance Department to compile and verify essential yearly audit documentation related to the loan funds. Supervises external compliance and outcomes for critical small business technical assistance contracts, including partnerships with Working Solutions (for the management of the loan funds) and Project Equity for employee-ownership and business succession planning assistance.

**Data Analysis & Event Production**

- **Workload Allocation**: **15% of total time** (~6 hours/week, seasonal).
- **Primary Impact**: Powers citywide economic intelligence tracking and supports high-visibility economic development events.
- **Key Responsibilities**: Tracks local economic indicators by designing, coordinating and executing field collection protocols for commercial district inventory (storefront vacancy data), performing complex sales tax analyses, producing employment data metrics, and producing the city's published economic dashboard. Conceptualizes, plans, supports and assists with executing major annual economic events, including the Small Business Forum and Manufacturing Week.

**Interdepartmental Policy & Strategic Research Support**

- **Workload Allocation**: **10% of total time** (~4 hours/week).
- **Primary Impact**: Aligns cross-departmental operations and delivers rapid-response policy research to support active City Council and mayoral legislative priorities.
- **Key Responsibilities**: Conducts quick-turnaround policy research and stakeholder outreach on sensitive, evolving council directives. Provides support and assistance (and an economic development/small business perspective) in consultation with other city departments on work initiatives. Recent examples include, working with the Planning Department on corridor zoning changes, collaborating with Code Enforcement on implementing vacant storefront accountability programs, and working with the Zero Waste division to deploy commercial infrastructure, including street-level trash receptacles on Euclid Avenue's commercial district, and offering education to merchants on embracing reusable food ware initiatives.